AffiGenie / Cheetah AI Writer & Chatbot

Complete User & Operator Documentation
How to Use Every Feature



Landing / Marketing Visual (from project assets)

Based on project README (AffiGenie Operator Documentation) & full source inventory

Client delivery — October 2026

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1. Product Overview

AffiGenie (Cheetah AI Writer and Chatbot in the repository) is a full-stack AI writing and affiliate-publishing web application. Stack: Next.js App Router (localized routes under src/app/[lang]), JavaScript/JSX, MUI + Vuexy layout, Prisma ORM (MySQL), NextAuth (credentials + Google).

Main product flow: Select a writer type → configure article → generate outline → generate sections → edit → save draft or publish.

Key capabilities:

- Specialized AI article types (blog, listicle, Amazon roundups/reviews, product comparison, YouTube-to-blog, rewrite flows).
- Amazon PA-API for product data and affiliate link construction.
- Standalone AI image generation with history and optional TinyPNG compression.
- In-app AI Chat.
- Lead-magnet tools and link analysis/crawling.
- Draft storage and management.
- Stripe subscription billing (Pro) + Customer Portal.
- WordPress one-click publishing with featured image.
- Private Admin console (users, feature flags, word limits, pricing copy).
- Multi-language front-end (en / fr / ar).
- Newsletter subscription (separate from Stripe).

LLM provider order in shared callLLM: 1) xAI / Grok → 2) Mistral → 3) Groq → 4) Gemini (key-pool rotation on quota/rate-limit/503).

2. Getting Started (Sign-up, Login, Plans)

2.1 Accessing the Application

After deployment open the public origin. Root redirects to /en/home (or chosen locale). Guests see marketing pages; authenticated users enter the private dashboard.

2.2 Registration & Login

• Register with email + password or Google OAuth via NextAuth.
• Login supports the same providers.
• Session managed by NextAuth; protected routes under (dashboard)/(private).

2.3 Plans & Entitlements

Server-side entitlement uses the Prisma user record. getDbUser loads it; assertCanGenerate checks the user and requested feature. Client-supplied role is never authoritative.

Plan / Role	Behavior
free	Uses feature access mode and the applicable free word limit (global + per-user).
pro	Considered paid by generation entitlement checks.
admin	Considered paid. Admin-console access also requires DB role admin + valid unlock cookie.

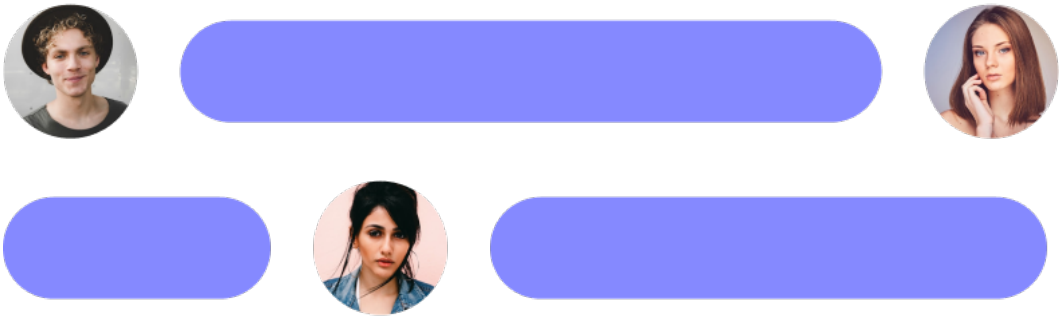
Feature access modes are free / pro / off. Missing configured flags are seeded without wiping users.

3. Dashboard & Navigation

After login the private dashboard is shown. Vertical navigation (Vuexy-based) typically includes:

- Home – overview / private landing
- Writer – main article generation UI
- Chat – AI chatbot
- Images – standalone image generator
- Drafts – saved article drafts
- Links – affiliate link crawl / analysis
- Magnets – lead-magnet configuration & generation
- Calendar – content / event calendar
- Account – profile, password, settings
- Pricing – plan comparison & upgrade
- Admin (only for unlocked admins)

Language switcher (en / fr / ar) is present; routes are locale-prefixed. Theme customizer (light/dark, layout) is part of core components.



Chat-related UI asset from project public assets

4. AI Writer — All Article Types

Entry: /writer. Article Type Menu (ArticleTypeMenu.jsx) presents these types (IDs dispatched by /api/generate):

ID	Display Name	Purpose
blog	Blog Post	Standard keyword-led article
listicle	Listicle	Article organized as a list
local-roundup	Local Places Roundup	Local places/business roundup
amazon-roundup	Amazon Product Roundup	Amazon product roundup + affiliate links
amazon-review	Amazon Single Product Review	Review of one Amazon product
product-comparison	Product Comparison	Compare 2–3 product URLs
youtube-blog	YouTube Video to Blog Post	Video-to-article flow
rewrite	Rewrite Blog Post	Rewrite an existing article URL
amazon-roundup-rewrite	Rewrite Amazon Product Roundup	Rewrite existing Amazon roundup
amazon-review-rewrite	Rewrite Amazon Single Product Review	Rewrite existing Amazon review

4.1 Product Comparison

Form has two required product URL inputs + optional third. Server validates 2–3 URLs. Reuses Amazon roundup helpers. Article contains product evaluations, responsive comparison table, FAQs, final verdict. Sections run with concurrency 1.

4.2 Amazon Roundup Layouts

roundupLayout accepts table (default) or top-pick. Product Table uses shared responsive table renderer (.affigenie-table mobile-card CSS). Top Pick uses ranked cards; first card gets Top Pick mark. Always check mobile widths before publishing.

4.3 Batch Generation

POST /api/generate/batch accepts an articles array. Requires batch-generate entitlement (Pro). UI: one keyword per line. 402/403 shows Pro-upgrade message. Batch state currently held in process memory.

5. Generation Pipeline (Outline → Sections → Edit → Publish)

1. Select type + fill configuration (keyword, URLs, tone, length, etc.).
2. Client POSTs to /api/generate for outline.
3. ArticleEditor requests individual sections (service-specific handlers).
4. Some flows obtain Amazon product data, SERP data, or relevant images during outline/setup or section work.
5. Edit the generated HTML in the rich editor.
6. Save as draft or Publish (WordPress if entitled).

Shared helpers (articleHtml.js): English affiliate CTA “Check Price on Amazon”, Amazon affiliate URL resolution & ASIN construction, renderResponsiveTable, renderTopPickCards, article HTML preparation/finalization. Errors go through serializeError for clean user messages.

6. Chatbot / AI Chat

Chat page provides a conversational interface using the same LLM stack. Ask questions, request rewrites, brainstorm topics, or get content-strategy help. Conversation history is kept in the UI/session. Backend: /api/chat.

Usage: open Chat from sidebar → type prompt → receive response → continue thread or start new.

7. Image Generator

Standalone page: ImageGeneratorBoard. API: /api/generate-image.

• GET – signed-in user's image history.
• POST – requires image-standalone entitlement; progress/results over SSE. UI states: Preparing → Generating → Done / Error. Generate disabled while stream active.
• DELETE – DB admin only; removes image records globally.
TinyPNG compression attempted when lossless disabled; original retained on failure.

Stock-image helpers for articles use Pexels, Pixabay, Unsplash when configured. pickRelevantImages scores candidates. Branded-hero prefers relevant photo, falls back to branded gradient.

8. Drafts Management

Generated articles can be saved as drafts. Drafts page lists the user’s work. Authenticated draft operations via dedicated endpoints. From a draft: reopen editor, continue generation, or publish.

9. Affiliate Links Tools

Links page + POST /api/links support link-crawl and analyze operations. Useful for extracting product data, checking affiliate link health, or preparing data for Amazon roundups/reviews.

10. Lead Magnets

Magnets page + POST /api/magnets handle lead-magnet configuration and execution. Define and generate lead magnets (checklists, mini-guides, email-capture assets) that support the affiliate content strategy.

11. Calendar

Content calendar (Calendar.jsx + sidebars). Schedule publishing dates, content ideas, or reminders. Add events via Add Event sidebar. Backend: /api/calendar.

12. Account, Settings & Billing (Stripe)

12.1 Account Settings

Account page: profile + password change (POST /api/user/password – current + new password). GET/PATCH /api/user/settings for supported profile updates.

12.2 Pricing & Upgrade

Pricing page shows plan comparison (copy editable by admin). Upgrade starts Stripe Checkout via POST /api/billing/checkout using STRIPE_PRO_PRICE_ID.

12.3 Customer Portal

POST /api/billing/portal opens the Stripe Customer Portal for the signed-in customer (payment method, cancel, invoices).

12.4 Webhooks

POST /api/billing/webhook must be registered in Stripe Dashboard and subscribed to: checkout.session.completed, customer.subscription.created/updated/deleted, customer.deleted. App only updates access after verifying Stripe signature (STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET).



Pricing illustration from project assets

13. WordPress Publishing

POST /api/publish checks wp-publish entitlement. Can upload featured image and set returned media ID as WordPress featured_media. Hero is also retained in article content when applicable. Failures returned via serializeError.

Prerequisite: user must have configured WordPress site credentials (URL, username, application password) in account settings.

14. Admin Console (Operators)

Requires DB role = admin AND valid unlock cookie (POST /api/admin/unlock with unlock key). POST /api/admin/lock clears the cookie.

Tabs:

- **Overview** – statistics from /api/admin/stats (user counts, generation volume, global free-word cap).
- **Users** – list / create / update / delete (password hashes never returned). Guards: cannot delete last admin, cannot self-demote/delete. Deleting a user does not delete WordPress posts.
- **Feature flags** – set free / pro / off per feature; missing flags seeded.
- **Limits** – global free-word cap + per-user word limits.
- **Pricing copy** – display-only text for Pricing page; does not touch Stripe products or prices.

15. Feature Flags, Limits & Entitlements

Feature access modes stored in DB and read by entitlement checks. Typical flags control batch-generate, image-standalone, wp-publish, and individual writer capabilities. Free users limited by feature mode + word quota. Pro and admin bypass free-word limits for generation.

16. Environment & Deployment Notes

MySQL required (Prisma). Key environment variable groups (values are secrets – never commit):

- Database / Auth: DATABASE_URL, NEXTAUTH_SECRET, NEXTAUTH_URL
- OAuth: Google client ID/secret (if enabled)
- Stripe: STRIPE_SECRET_KEY, STRIPE_PRO_PRICE_ID, STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET, NEXT_PUBLIC_STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY
- LLM: GEMINI_API_KEYS (comma-separated pool) + other provider keys (xAI, Mistral, Groq)
- Amazon: PA-API credentials
- Image stocks: Pexels / Pixabay / Unsplash keys
- Mail / SMTP for newsletter & transactional mail
- Mapbox (if used for local-roundup geo)
- BASEPATH (optional sub-path deployments)

Deployment: Next.js standalone output configured. Stripe webhook must be publicly reachable. Register the events listed in §12. Configure Stripe Customer Portal in Dashboard.

Local: pnpm/npm/yarn install → set .env → MySQL running + Prisma migrate → pnpm dev → http://localhost:3000.

17. API Surface Summary

Selected routes (full list in project README):

Route	Methods	Purpose
/api/generate	POST	Outline / section generation
/api/generate/batch	POST	Batch article generation
/api/generate-image	GET/POST/DELETE	Standalone images + history
/api/publish	POST	WordPress publish
/api/chat	POST	AI Chat
/api/user/password	POST	Change password
/api/user/settings	GET/PATCH	Account settings
/api/billing/checkout	POST	Stripe checkout session
/api/billing/portal	POST	Stripe customer portal
/api/billing/webhook	POST	Signed Stripe events
/api/admin/*	various	Users, flags, stats, settings, unlock/lock
/api/links	POST	Link crawl / analyze
/api/magnets	POST	Lead-magnet flow

18. Troubleshooting & Best Practices

- Generation fails with 402/403 → user lacks entitlement or word quota exhausted; upgrade or wait for reset.
- Amazon data missing → verify PA-API credentials and that product URLs are valid Amazon product pages.
- Images not generating → check image-standalone flag and stock-provider keys; watch SSE status in UI.
- WordPress publish fails → confirm application password, site URL, and wp-publish entitlement.
- Admin console inaccessible → confirm DB role is admin and unlock cookie is present.
- Stripe portal / checkout errors → verify all Stripe env vars and that the webhook is correctly registered and signature-verified.
- Always preview Amazon roundups (especially Top-Pick layout) on mobile before publishing.
- Prefer serializeError for any custom error display so users never see raw [object Object].
- Batch jobs: state is in-memory; process restarts clear pending batches.
- Keep LLM key pools rotated; Gemini pool automatically advances on quota/rate-limit/503.

This documentation was generated from the project's README (AffiGenie Operator Documentation) and a complete inventory of routes and views in the supplied source zip. Live application screenshots were not captured because a full MySQL-backed runtime with all external API keys could not be started in the documentation environment. If a tutorial video is later supplied, high-resolution screenshots can be inserted into a revised PDF. For production-grade user tutorials, consider engaging a fluent English technical writer / video creator on Upwork as suggested in the client message.

— End of AffiGenie / Cheetah AI Writer & Chatbot User Documentation —